

Warm Contact List Mining Guide

The goal of “mining your contacts” is to find people who already know, like, and trust you. This reduces friction and eliminates the “cold” feeling of outreach.

Top Sources to Mine

Source	Where to Look	Examples of Who to Add
Mobile Contacts	Scroll text threads and address book.	Former colleagues, old bosses, or business owner friends.
Email History	Search “Sent” folder for past collaborations.	Past clients, vendors, or people consulted informally.
LinkedIn	Check 1st-degree connections and profile views.	Industry peers or former coworkers in new roles.
Social Media	DMs and post engagement (IG/FB).	Engaged followers or old classmates who started firms.
Niche Communities	Slack, Discord, or Facebook Groups.	Members you’ve had 1-on-1 conversations with.

Viable vs. Non-Viable Contacts

Use this “Vibe Check” to filter your network effectively.

✓ Viable (Add Them)

- ✓ **The “Handshake” Rule:** Would you say hello at a coffee shop?
- ✓ **Relevant Context:** They own a business or manage a team.
- ✓ **Recent Interaction:** You’ve spoken within the last 1-2 years.
- ✓ **Mutual Respect:** They view you as a professional peer.

× Not Viable (Skip Them)

- × **The “Who?” Factor:** No idea how they ended up in your contacts.
- × **Burned Bridges:** Anyone with a significant past falling out.
- × **The “Cold” Warm:** Connected years ago but never exchanged a word.

Pro Tip: Don’t overthink the “perfect” person. Focus on the “warmest” person.